★ Recipe No. 01 ★

Fudge Brownies

No scale. No problem.

Big chocolate energy. Tiny measuring-cup effort.

30 min prep · 35 min bake · 24 squares, 5 × 5 cm

The good stuff

Cups + spoons · Metric

dark couverture chocolate 175 g · finely chopped	1 cup + 1½ tsp
unsalted butter 115 g	½ cup (8 tbsp)
unsweetened cocoa powder 30 g	¼ cup + 1 tbsp + 2 tsp
plain flour 250 g · Type 405 or all-purpose	2 cups + 1 tbsp + 1 tsp
salt ½ tsp	½ tsp
eggs 4 · European size M	4
white granulated sugar 400 g	2 cups
vanilla extract 1 tsp	1 tsp
buttermilk 60 ml	¼ cup (4 tbsp)

Let's make a mess.

20 × 30 cm baking frame or tin (or a 26 cm springform), baking paper, heatproof bowl over simmering water, sieve.

1. **Heat things up.**
   Heat the oven to 180 °C conventional / 160 °C fan. Line a tray with baking paper and set a 20 × 30 cm frame on it (a 26 cm springform works too).
   → *Oven fully preheated before the batter goes in.*

2. **Melt the magic.**
   Melt the chopped chocolate and butter over simmering water. Let it cool slightly. Mix cocoa, flour and salt and sift them together.
   → *Glossy and smooth, warm but not hot.*

3. **Bring it together.**
   Beat eggs, sugar and vanilla to a cream. Stir in the chocolate butter, then the flour mix in three batches. Pour in the buttermilk slowly at the end.
   → *Thick, shiny batter with no dry streaks.*

4. **Into the oven.**
   Spread the batter into the frame and bake for about 35 minutes.
   → *Top set and crackly; a skewer comes out with moist crumbs.*

5. **The hard part: wait.**
   Let it cool completely. Chill for 2 more hours if you like a firmer bite, then cut into 5 × 5 cm squares. Keeps up to 3 days airtight.
   → *Fully cold = clean cuts.*

Scoop smart.

1 cup ≈ 240 ml · 1 tbsp = 15 ml · 1 tsp = 5 ml. Use measuring cups, not mugs. Spoon flour and cocoa in lightly, then level. Pack butter without air gaps.

Chocolate cheat code.

Chopped chocolate varies by size. For accuracy, use 1¾ bars of 100 g (175 g). All cup conversions are approximate.

Recipe: Franziska Klausmann / Einfach Backen

Cup conversions: King Arthur Baking